Stele 1.0 — Quick Start

Carve the model into stone.

Stele archives Hugging Face AI models (and a few official runtimes) onto M-DISC optical discs, or into ISO images, so you keep a copy that does not depend on anyone's servers.

1. Install (portable, no installer)

1. Unzip the Stele folder anywhere you like, for example C:\Tools\Stele.
2. Double-click Stele.exe.
3. Stele is not code-signed yet, so Windows SmartScreen may warn you. Choose "More info", then "Run anyway".
4. Read the license agreement and click Accept. (Decline closes Stele.)

You need: a Windows PC, an internet connection for downloads, and for burning, a disc writer and blank discs (BD-R or M-DISC). No writer? You can still Export ISO.

First launch creates these folders:

```
%USERPROFILE%\Stele\vault\      finished models and runtimes
%USERPROFILE%\Stele\staging\    the download in progress
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Stele\           database, logs and disc work area
```

You can move vault and staging in Workspace settings.

2. Free vs Pro

Free: search the Hub, download, generate the docs, Export ISO.

Pro: everything in Free, plus burning discs and spanning one archive across several discs. One-time purchase on Gumroad.

3. Activate Pro

1. Find your license key in your Gumroad receipt email.
2. In Stele, click "Workspace settings" (bottom left).
3. Under "Stele Pro", paste the key and click Activate.
4. The badge at the top right changes from Free to Pro.

Activation checks the key with Gumroad, so be online the first time. After that, Pro keeps working offline for 14 days from the last successful check; then Stele needs to go online once. A refunded or disabled key stops unlocking Pro at the next check.

Where your license lives:

- The key itself: Windows Credential Manager, entry "Stele".
- The status (Free/Pro, last check): Stele's database in %LOCALAPPDATA%\Stele\stele.db.

Moving to a new PC? Click Deactivate on the old one, then activate on the new one with the same key.

4. Your first archive

1. Discover: search for a model (repository id or keywords) and select it.
2. Pick a revision and a profile ("GGUF inference pack" is the usual choice for running models locally).
3. Read the model's license, tick "I acknowledge the model license", then Add to Queue. Gated models also need a Hugging Face token (Workspace settings > Hugging Face) and the license accepted on the Hub itself.
4. Queue: files download one at a time. Pause keeps partial files; Resume picks up where it stopped.
5. Library: when the download finishes, select it and click "Add to burn set".

6. Burn: choose your recorder, insert a blank, click "Burn disc" (Pro). Stele writes a closed UDF disc and, by default, reads it back to verify every file against its checksum. If the archive is bigger than one disc, Pro asks you to insert the next disc when ready. Or click Export ISO (free) to get the same disc layout as .iso files.

Each disc contains a STELE folder with README_FIRST.txt, the docs, the model files, checksums.sha256 and RESTORE.ps1 (copies everything back to a folder you choose, offline, without running installers).

5. Good to know

- Stele does not grant redistribution rights. Each model keeps its own license.
- Some USB disc enclosures do not work well with Windows' burning engine (IMAPI2). Export ISO is the dependable path there.
- DVD M-DISC may need an M-DISC-aware drive. Stele cannot always tell an M-DISC blank from an ordinary BD-R, so check the blank yourself.
- A single file larger than the disc is never split. Use a larger disc or Export ISO.
- Optical media can fail. Verify your discs and keep more than one copy of anything you cannot afford to lose.

6. Help

Email: alexx.forge@proton.me

Or reply to your Gumroad receipt email.

Logs (useful when asking for help): Workspace settings > Open log folder.

License agreement and open-source notices: Workspace settings > About and licenses.